

WILLOW CREEK CITY HALL

2026 Action Plan — Active Mobility Development: New Bike Lanes and Pedestrian Zones

Publication date: November 15, 2025 Lead department: Public Works — Urban Planning and Mobility
Approved by: City Council on November 10, 2025

1. Introduction and Context

In response to environmental challenges, the need to improve air quality and quality of life, and growing resident demand for active transportation options, Willow Creek is committing to a stronger active mobility strategy.

Building on previous work such as street renovation projects with selected cycling improvements and lower-speed neighborhood zones, this 2026 action plan is designed to accelerate the development of a connected, safer bike network and to test new pedestrian-friendly public spaces.

Main objectives for 2026:

- Create approximately 1.6 miles (2.5 km) of new protected cycling facilities.
- Launch a temporary pedestrian-zone pilot and create a shared street area.
- Improve cyclist and pedestrian safety at key conflict points.
- Make biking and walking more attractive options for everyday local trips.

2. Strategic Priorities

1. Create and expand the bike network: develop continuous, protected routes for bike travel.
2. Calm traffic and prioritize pedestrians: create public spaces that are safer and more welcoming for walking.
3. Secure routes and address safety hotspots: improve areas identified as risky for active mobility users.
4. Communicate and support adoption: inform residents and encourage the use of active transportation.

3. Detailed 2026 Action Plan

Strategic Area	Action	Summary Description	Estimated Budget	Timeline
1. Bike Network	1.1 Main Street protected bike lane (City Hall-Station segment)	Build a two-way protected bike lane separated from traffic (0.75 mi / 1.2 km).	\$180,000	Q1-Q3 2026
	1.2 Mill Street bike lanes	Mark bike lanes in both directions over 0.5 mi / 0.8 km.	\$25,000	Q2 2026
	1.3 Park-to-Creek greenway	Create a dedicated active-mobility connection between Municipal Park and the improved creekfront (0.3 mi / 0.5 km).	\$60,000	Q3-Q4 2026
	1.4 Bike rack installation	Install 50 new bike racks downtown, near schools, and at public facilities.	\$15,000	Q1-Q4 2026
2. Pedestrian Zones	2.1 Grand Oak Square pilot	Pilot temporary pedestrianization on Saturday mornings with movable signage and public communication.	\$5,000	April-October 2026
	2.2 Pasteur Street shared street	Create a shared street area with a 15 mph speed limit, pedestrian priority, signage, and light street furniture.	\$30,000	Q3 2026
3. Safety Improvements	3.1 Station/Main intersection	Redesign the intersection with a raised crossing, signal changes, and specific bike/pedestrian markings.	\$45,000	Q2-Q3 2026
	3.2 Lighting near bike facilities	Upgrade LED street lighting on three existing bike-lane segments identified as underlit.	\$20,000	Q4 2026
4. Communication	4.1 Active mobility campaign	Share information through the municipal bulletin, website, posters, and a public meeting on the new facilities and road sharing.	\$8,000	Throughout 2026
	4.2 Bike route map	Create and distribute an updated map of bike lanes, bike routes, and greenways in town.	\$7,000	Q4 2026
TOTAL 2026 FORECAST			\$395,000	

4. Overall 2026 Budget Forecast

The total estimated budget for implementing this 2026 action plan is \$395,000 before tax. Funding will come from:

- Municipal capital investment budget: amount to be confirmed, e.g. \$295,000.
- Grant applications from county, state, and federal active transportation programs: target amount to be confirmed, e.g. \$100,000.

5. Governance and Monitoring

The plan will be led by the Deputy Mayor for Urban Planning and Mobility in close coordination with Public Works. A monitoring committee including elected officials, technical staff, and user representatives such as cycling groups and neighborhood committees will meet quarterly to review progress and propose adjustments.

Tracking indicators will include miles completed, bike-lane usage through counters, number of racks installed, and resident feedback.

6. Conclusion

This 2026 action plan marks an important step in Willow Creek's transition toward a healthier, more sustainable, and more pleasant town. By actively supporting walking and biking, City Hall aims to improve road safety, reduce pollution, and provide real alternatives to individual car use for short local trips.

The success of the plan will depend not only on high-quality implementation but also on residents adopting and using the new facilities.

Issued in Willow Creek on November 15, 2025

For the Mayor and by delegation,
Deputy Mayor for Urban Planning and Mobility
[Deputy Mayor Name]